Investigator Examination Notes

Case DF-2026-1102-017 | Host ci-worker-03 | All times UTC | Incident date 2026-10-29

Examination Plan

Review the scoped auth, sudo, filesystem, process and network exports. Work only on read-only copies. Preserve original timestamps in UTC and record both positive and negative findings.

Command Notebook

journalctl --since "2026-10-29 08:30:00 UTC" --until "2026-10-29 10:15:00 UTC" -u ssh --no-pager

grep -E "Accepted publickey|Failed password|sudo" auth.log

stat -c "%n %U %G %s %y" home/worker/.config/systemd/user/ci-health.service

systemctl --user cat ci-health.service (live-host command; do not run on seized originals)

ps -eo pid,user,pcpu,args --sort=-pcpu | head

sha256sum evidence/* (illustrative workflow only)

Authentication Notes

08:41:02 failed password, 08:41:19 accepted publickey, same 192.168.4.35. Key fingerprint requires comparison to authorized_keys; no attribution to an individual.

Configuration and Persistence Notes

Staging files and a hidden Python path suggest access and execution beyond routine build tasks. Unit contents: [Unit] Description=CI health worker; [Service] ExecStart=/usr/bin/python3 /home/worker/.local/share/.ci_health.py; Restart=always; [Install] WantedBy=default.target.

CPU and Network Notes

PID 18422 reached 96.4% CPU at 09:03:17. HTTPS POST to 198.51.100.24 was attempted at 08:48:09; no HTTP response preserved. Do not infer successful delivery.

Analyst Decision Log

09:14 open incident; 09:22 isolate host; 09:36 begin logical exports; 10:08 finish export; preserve originals and analyze copies. Investigate alternative causes of CPU use and whether SSH access was authorized.

Limitations and Follow-Up

No memory image, full disk image, TLS decryption, remote server logs or CI key issuance records. Request centralized proxy logs, authorized_keys change history, change tickets and secret-access audit records before closing the incident.